

Asking for a Promotion

Daring to ask, and making the case for your value

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Daring to ask, and making the case for your value

Waiting for your work to be noticed often isn't enough: promotions go to those who know how to ask. And asking is prepared — without having to betray yourself.

This guide helps you move past what holds you back, recognize your value, and prepare a solid request.

Your intention

The promotion or move you're aiming for: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

What stops you from asking

'I should wait to be offered it', the fear of bothering, the belief that asking would be 'arrogant': these reflexes often come from an upbringing toward discretion or modesty.

Spotting them means no longer sabotaging your own progress.

Example

Raised to 'not put herself forward', Aïcha had waited for years. Understanding the reflex helped her dare.

What holds me back

What stops me from asking? Where does this restraint come from?

The cost of waiting

What may waiting 'to be noticed' have already cost me?

→ *Asking isn't arrogant — it's normal and legitimate.*

The thoughts that hold you back

'I don't deserve it yet', 'they'll say no', 'I'll embarrass myself': these thoughts push the request off indefinitely.

Testing them against the facts (your results) gets you moving.

Example

Sure he 'didn't deserve it yet', Marc listed his results. The proof was there.

Blockers journal

Note: the thought that holds you back · the fact that contradicts it.

Reframe the 'no'

Turn 'they'll say no' into 'a no opens the conversation about the path forward'.

→ *My results speak — a 'no' isn't a humiliation.*

Recognizing your value

You have the right to aim higher. Recognizing your real contribution — your wins, what you bring to the team — isn't arrogance: it's clarity.

Your value doesn't shrink because you dare to name it.

Example

Daring to list all she carried without the official title, Léa realized she was already doing the target role.

My real contribution

List your wins and responsibilities, even those 'outside the job description'.

My right to aim higher

Write why you're legitimate for this higher level.

→ *Naming my value isn't arrogance — it's clarity.*

Preparing your request

A solid request: quantify your results, choose the right moment (after a win, at the annual review), state clearly what you're asking for, anticipate objections, and have a plan B (the path forward if it's 'not yet').

A prepared request is far more convincing.

Example

Arriving with quantified results and a clear request, Sofia got a 'yes' — or failing that, a dated plan.

My case

Note: 3 quantified results · what I'm asking for precisely · the right moment.

Objections & plan B

Anticipate 2 objections + your reply, and the question 'what do I need to get there?'.

→ *A prepared, quantified request convinces.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Document your quantified wins continuously (not just before the meeting).
- Choose the right moment: after a win, at the annual review.
- State a clear request (role, responsibilities, pay).
- Argue on the value you bring, not seniority.
- Anticipate objections; if it's 'no', ask for the precise path.
- This is a negotiation strategy, not financial advice.

To fill in

My promotion case

Quantified result	How it serves the team/company

Objections

Anticipated objection	My reply

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Spot what stops me from asking.

Week 2 — Test my blockers against facts.

Week 3 — Recognize my real contribution.

Week 4 — Prepare my request (case, timing).

Your plan in 3 lines

- The promotion I aim for:
- My 3 quantified results:
- The moment I choose:

TO CLOSE

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This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.